walk before running, similarly one picks up advanced skills only after picking the basic foundational skills. The advent of the knowledge economy poses new challenges, and one of the severe consequences of having an uneducated workforce will be our inability to keep pace with the global economy. Without a strong learning foundation at the primary level, there can be no improvement in higher education or skill development.

53. Which one of the following statements best reflects the crux of the passage?

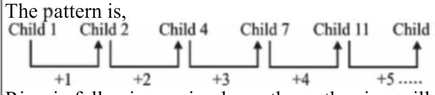
(a) To become a global power, India needs to invest in universal quality education.
(b) India is unable to become a global power because it is not focussing or promoting knowledge economy.
(c) Our education system should focus more on imparting skills during higher education.
(d) Parents of many school children are illiterate and are unaware of the benefits of quality education.

Ans. (c) : Statement that best reflects the curse of the passage is- "Our education system should focus more on imparting skills during higher education."

54. 40 children are standing in a circle and one of them (say child-1) has a ring. The ring is passed clockwise. Child-1 passes on to child-2, child-2 passes on to child-4, child-4 passes on to child-7 and so on. After how many such changes (including child-1) will the ring be in the hands of child-1 again?

(a) 14 (b) 15
(c) 16 (d) 17

Ans. (b) : According to the given,
The pattern is,



Ring is following a circular path, so the ring will come back to 1st child if the number in the pattern is (40x + 1), like 41st, 81st, 121st etc.

(i)	1 – 2	(ix)	37 – 46
(ii)	2 – 4	(x)	46 – 56
(iii)	4 – 7	(xi)	56 – 67
(iv)	7 – 11	(xii)	67 – 79
(v)	11 – 16	(xiii)	79 – 92
(vi)	16 – 22	(xiv)	92 – 106
(vii)	22 – 29	(xv)	106 – 121
(viii)	29 – 37		

Therefore, after 15 changes, the ring will be in the hands of child one again.

55. What is the middle term of the sequence Z, Z, Y, Y, Y, X, X, X, X, W, W, W, W, W, ..., A?

(a) H (b) I
(c) J (d) M

Ans. (a) : In the given sequence, the total number of terms = 2 + 3 + ... + 27

$$\text{Sum} = S_n = \frac{n}{2}(2a + (n-1)d)$$

$$= \frac{26}{2}(2 \times 2 + (26-1)1) = \frac{26}{2}(4+25)$$

$$= \frac{26 \times 29}{2} = 13 \times 29 = 377$$

$$\text{So, middle term} = \frac{377+1}{2} = 189^{th} \text{ term}$$

Therefore, 2 + 3 + 4 + ... x ≤ 189
x (x + 1) ≤ 380
x = 19 satisfies the condition.
So, the 19th letter (starting from Z) would be 8th letter (2 – 19 = 8) starting form A, which is H.

56. Question : Is p greater than q?
Statement-1: p × q is greater than zero.
Statement-2: p^2 is greater than q^2.
Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above Question and the Statements?

(a) The Question can be answered by using one of the Statements alone, but cannot be answered using the other Statement alone.
(b) The Question can be answered by using either Statement alone.
(c) The Question can be answered by using both the Statements together, but cannot be answered using either Statement alone.
(d) The Question cannot be answered even by using both the Statements together.

Ans. (d) : According to the given,
Statement I:- p × q > 0
It means that p and q are non - zero and both have the same sign.
Statement II:- $p^2 > q^2$
It means that both p and q can have positive or negative values. For example values of p and q can be (2, 1) or (– 2, – 1).
So, the question can not be answered even by using both the statements together.

57. Question : Is (p + q – r) greater than (p – q + r), where p, q and r are integers?
Statement-1 : (p – q) is positive.
Statement-2 : (p – r) is negative.
Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above Question and the Statements?

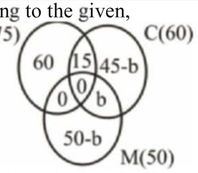
(a) The Question can be answered by using one of the Statement alone, but cannot be answered using the other Statement alone.
(b) The Question can be answered by using either Statement alone.
(c) The Question can be answered by using both the Statements together, but cannot be answered using either Statement alone.
(d) The Question cannot be answered even by using both the Statements together.

Ans. (c) : If p + q – r > p – q + r
Then q > r
Statement 1:- (p – q) is positive
Statement 2:- (p – r) is negative
From Statement 1**:-** p – q > 0
= p > q
From Statement 2:**-** p – r < 0
p < r
So, r > p > q
The question can be answered by using both the statements together but cannot be answered using either statement alone.

58. In a party, 75 persons took tea, 60 persons took coffee and 15 persons took both tea and coffee. No one taking milk takes tea. Each person takes at least one drink.
Question : How many persons attended the party?
Statement-1 : 50 persons took milk.
Statement-2 : Number of persons who attended the party is five times the number of persons who took milk only.
Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above Question and the Statements?

(a) The Question can be answered by using one of the Statements alone, but cannot be answered using the other Statement alone.
(b) The Question can be answered by using either Statement alone.
(c) The Question can be answered by using both the Statements together, but cannot be answered using either Statement alone.
(d) The Question cannot be answered even by using both the Statements together.

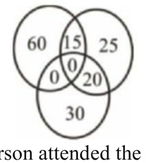
Ans. (c) : According to the given,



60 + 15 + 45 – b + b + 50 – b = 5 (50 – b)
120 + 50 – b = 5 (50 – b)
120 + 50 – b = 250 – 5b
4b = 80

$$b = \frac{80}{4} = 20$$

Therefore,



Total number of person attended the party
= 60 + 15 + 25 + 20 + 30
= 150
The question can be answered by using both the statements together but cannot be answered using either statement alone.

59. Consider a 3-digit number.
Question: What is the number?
Statement-1: The sum of the digits of the number is equal to the product of the digits.
Statement-2: The number is divisible by the sum of the digits of the number.
Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above Question and the Statements?

(a) The Question can be answered by using one of the Statements alone, but cannot be answered using the other Statement alone.
(b) The Question can be answered by using either Statement alone.
(c) The Question can be answered by using both the Statements together, but cannot be answered using either Statement alone.
(d) The Question cannot be answered even by using both the Statements together.

Ans. (d) : According to the given,
Let the digits are x, y and z
Statement 1:- x + y + z = x y z

Statement 2:- $\frac{100x + 10y + z}{x + y + z}$

So, the number cannot be found even by using both the statements together.

60. For five children with ages a < b < c < d < e; any two successive ages differ by 2 years.
Question : What is the age of the youngest child?
Statement-1 : What is the age of the youngest child?
Statement-2 : The average age of the children is 8 years.
Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above Question and the Statement?

(a) The Question can be answered by using one of the Statements alone, but cannot be answered using the other Statement alone.
(b) The Question can be answered by using either Statement alone.
(c) The Question can be answered by using both the Statements together, but cannot be answered using either Statement alone.
(d) The Question cannot be answered even by using both the Statements together.

Ans. (b) : According to the given, Sequence of the age is a < b < c < d < e and two successive age differ by 2 years
Statement 1:- e = 3a
Since, e = a + 8
Therefore, a + 8 = 3a
2a = 8
a = 4 years

Statement - 2:- $\frac{a+b+c+d+e}{5} = 8$

$$\frac{a + (a+2) + (a+4) + (a+6) + (a+8)}{5} = 8$$

5a + 20 = 40
5a = 20
a = 4 years
Hence, the question can be answered by using either statement alone.

Directions for the following 4 (four) items:
Read the following four passages and answer the items that follow the passages. Your answers to these items should be based on the passages only.

Passage–1

The paradox of choice is illustrated by the story of Buridan's ass. Jean Buridan, the 14th century philosopher, wrote about free will and the inability to choose due to numerous choices and uncertainties. In the story, a donkey stands between two equally appealing stacks of hay. Unable to decide which to eat, if starves to death. Changes in technology and innovations such as smart